

CivicMitra: Deep Problem Definition

Local governments across India face persistent challenges in promptly identifying, prioritizing, and resolving everyday civic issues such as potholes, malfunctioning streetlights, garbage overflow, broken drainage systems, and encroachments. Citizens encounter these issues daily, yet effective reporting and systematic redressal remain limited due to fragmented systems and lack of integration. Existing platforms like the Public Grievance Monitoring System (PGMS) in Jharkhand highlight both the potential and the limitations of current approaches. While PGMS enables complaint registration, it often suffers from delays in acknowledgement, lack of real-time tracking, insufficient feedback loops, and difficulties in managing high complaint volumes. These gaps lead to citizen dissatisfaction, eroded trust in governance, and inefficiencies in resource utilization. CivicMitra is conceptualized to directly address these challenges through a mobile-first, citizen-centric, and government-integrated approach.

The proposed system focuses on bridging the gap between citizens and local authorities through real-time issue reporting and transparent tracking mechanisms. Citizens will have access to a simple, mobile-first platform to capture civic problems instantly using photos, automatic GPS tagging, and short descriptions (text or voice). These reports feed into a centralized dashboard with an interactive map, allowing both citizens and administrators to visualize civic hotspots. Issues can be prioritized based on urgency, frequency, or impact on public safety and health. The system ensures inclusivity by supporting multiple languages and offline-first features for rural regions with limited internet access. For administrators, the platform provides a robust dashboard for filtering, categorizing, and routing complaints to relevant departments such as sanitation, waterworks, or electricity boards. Automated workflows and AI-assisted classification ensure efficiency and minimize human errors. Staff can update statuses, add notes, and communicate directly with citizens for clarification or updates. Scalability and resilience are key considerations: the backend will support concurrent usage during civic emergencies, handle high volumes of multimedia uploads, and integrate seamlessly with existing government databases for verification and analytics.

The expected deliverable is a comprehensive civic engagement ecosystem that strengthens citizen-government collaboration. Its core features include: 1. ****Mobile-first Citizen App**** – Easy-to-use reporting interface, photo and location capture, multi-language support, and real-time notifications for each stage of grievance handling (acknowledgment, progress, resolution). 2. ****Administrative Web Portal**** – Dashboard for categorization, task assignment, live status updates, and departmental collaboration. 3. ****Automated Routing Engine**** – Uses AI and metadata (location, category, urgency) to direct issues to the right department. 4. ****Scalable Backend Infrastructure**** – Supports concurrent users, high data volumes, and ensures security of citizen data. 5. ****Analytics & Insights**** – Trends in grievances, departmental response times, predictive hotspots, and

resource optimization suggestions. By addressing inefficiencies in systems like PGMS, CivicMitra not only improves response times but also builds accountability, transparency, and citizen trust in governance. It is a step toward smarter cities and empowered rural governance.